PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

How to recognize, resist and report phishing attacks

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PAUSE • VERIFY • REPORT

A practical guide to safer digital habits

What is phishing?

A social-engineering attack that uses deception to steal information, money or access.

THE BASIC IDEA

An attacker pretends to be a trusted person or company and tries to make you:

- Click a harmful link
- Open an unexpected file
- Share a password, OTP or payment details

EMAIL PHISHING

Fake bank, shop or service emails sent to many people.

SPEAR PHISHING

A targeted message tailored to a specific person or team.

SMISHING

Fraudulent SMS or messaging-app messages with links or requests.

VISHING

Voice calls impersonating bank, IT support or officials.

Goal: get you to act before you verify.

Spotting fake emails and websites

Look for several warning signs together—one clue alone does not prove a message is fake.

PHISHING EMAILS

- Sender address is almost right: support@paypa1.com
- Generic greeting: “Dear customer”
- Pressure or threat: “Account closed in 24 hours”
- Unexpected attachment, especially executable or archive files
- Odd wording, unusual requests or mismatched link text

FAKE WEBSITES

- Look-alike domains: amaz0n.com or bank-login.example
- Hover or long-press to preview the actual destination
- HTTPS/padlock means connection is encrypted—not that a site is genuine
- Requests for a PIN or OTP on an unexpected page
- Missing or inconsistent contact and company details

Safer habit: don't use the message link—open the official app or type the known website address.

Social engineering tactics

Attackers manipulate emotions and trust rather than relying only on technical tricks.

URGENCY

“Act now or lose access.”

FEAR

“Your account was hacked.”

AUTHORITY

Fake boss, bank, police or IT support.

GREED

Prize, refund or “easy money”.

CURIOSITY

“Is this you in this video?”

TRUST

Pretending to be a friend or colleague.

RULE OF THUMB **If a message makes you feel rushed, scared or excited: stop, then verify through a separate trusted channel.**

Real-world examples

Well-known incidents show how impersonation and convincing messages can lead to serious losses.

01 INVOICE FRAUD

2013–2015

Fraudsters impersonated a vendor and persuaded Google and Facebook to pay fake invoices; reported losses exceeded $100 million.

LESSON

Verify new bank details and payment changes using a known phone number.

02 CAMPAIGN EMAIL HACK

2016

A phishing email posing as a Google security alert contributed to the compromise of John Podesta’s email account.

LESSON

Avoid login links in unexpected alerts; use multi-factor authentication (MFA).

03 TWITTER BREACH

2020

Attackers used phone-based social engineering against employees to gain access to internal tools and hijack high-profile accounts.

LESSON

Verify support requests and restrict access to sensitive systems.

Everyday examples: fake courier SMS • bank KYC message • fraudulent job offer

Best practices to stay safe

A simple routine reduces the chance of losing an account or money.

01 PAUSE FIRST

Slow down before clicking or replying.

02 VERIFY SOURCE

Contact the organization using its official app or known number.

03 TYPE THE URL

Use a bookmark or type the trusted address yourself.

04 PROTECT ACCOUNTS

Use unique passwords, a password manager and MFA.

05 UPDATE SOFTWARE

Keep your operating system, browser and apps updated.

06 REPORT IT

Tell your IT team or bank; preserve details and follow their instructions.

NEVER SHARE YOUR OTP OR PIN.

India: report cybercrime at cybercrime.gov.in. For financial cyber fraud, call 1930 promptly.

Use official government channels; act quickly if money has been transferred.

Quick quiz

Choose the safest response. Answers are included in the presenter notes area on this slide.

Q1 ACCOUNT LOCKED

An email says your account will be locked in 24 hours. What should you do?

(A) Reply with details (B) Click quickly (C) Open the official site yourself

Q2 WHICH LINK?

Which address is the genuine-looking option?

(A) amaz0n.com/login (B) https://www.amazon.com (C) amazon.com.verify-now.net

Q3 OTP REQUEST

A caller claiming to be IT support asks for your OTP. What now?

(A) Hang up and call an official number (B) Share it (C) Share half

ANSWER KEY

C — **Q1**
Visit the official site independently.

B — **Q2**
Check the exact domain; look-alikes can deceive.

A — **Q3**
Never disclose an OTP—even to claimed support.

THANK YOU

Think before you click.

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